LA UNI × FEME / LEARNING NOTEBOOKS

Community co-creation guide

How to approach, listen, decide and provide support. Includes the explained checklist.

Replication starts with listening again

This pathway draws on the methodology used with the Collective. It offers a process of relationship-building and decision-making to adapt in each community, rather than a technical recipe or an intervention that must end in solar energy. People decide the problem, pace, solution and what is shared.

How to use this notebook

Follow the five phases in order. Each gives a purpose, actions, questions, an output and a condition for continuing. Return to an earlier phase if priorities change. Agree timing together: a phase may need more than one meeting. At the end, review the five checklist criteria; a checked box needs evidence and agreement, not simply workshop attendance.

Pathway	Minimum output
01 / Approach through invitation and agree the encounter	A simple entry agreement: provisional purpose, participant roles, timing, limits, decisions belonging to the community and rules for recording information.
02 / Listen to everyday life and set priorities together	Three priorities justified in terms of services, their timing and who benefits.
03 / Compare options and co-design a trial	An option comparison and a trial agreement: service, limits, budget, responsible roles, observations and review date.
04 / Put decisions into practice, learn and hand over together	An agreed handover: recorded technical tests, practical explanation, care rota, private support channel and first review date.
05 / Provide follow-up, evaluate and sustain the network	A joint review with agreed changes, a responsible person or institution by role, available resources and the next date.

The technical sequences and tables are in three separate notebooks: energy knowledge, solar thermal and photovoltaics. Use the adaptation plan to record agreements without collecting unnecessary personal information.

CO-CREATION PATHWAY / 01

Approach through invitation and agree the encounter

Build a relationship in which the community can accept, change or decline the proposal before committing time or resources.

What to do

Work with a trusted contact chosen by the community. Explain who you are, who funds the work, what you can offer, the budget limits and how long you can provide support. Ask who should participate and who is often left out. Agree language, timing, accessibility, travel, care arrangements and a private contact channel.

Questions for dialogue

Who is inviting us and who else should we hear? What do people expect from the encounter? What do they not want us to do or publish? How can they stop or change the process?

What to agree and keep

A simple entry agreement: provisional purpose, participant roles, timing, limits, decisions belonging to the community and rules for recording information. It does not need a public list of names.

When to continue or adapt

Continue when there is an accepted invitation and realistic conditions for participation. If a voice is missing or the timing is unsuitable, adjust the invitation or postpone. Do not begin with a purchase or a technology already decided.

Record for this phase:

Agreement to review	Responsible role	Next encounter
_____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____

CO-CREATION PATHWAY / 02

Listen to everyday life and set priorities together

Understand the service and wellbeing people seek before translating needs into panels, lamps or batteries.

What to do

Explore daily activities through voluntary accounts, drawings and cards. Ask about energy, safety, learning, water, cooking and care work. Offer small groups and ways to contribute without public exposure. Use the energy knowledge workshop to create a schematic map and set priorities. Distinguish shared needs, differences and urgent issues. Return the summary for the community to correct.

Questions for dialogue

Which activity cannot happen today and who is affected? What would feeling safer or having more time mean? Who would take on extra work? Which issues require another kind of support?

What to agree and keep

Three priorities justified in terms of services, their timing and who benefits. Keep disagreements and open questions visible. If use of the space, permissions or disputes arise, refer them to appropriate support and review whether work can proceed.

When to continue or adapt

Continue when the summary represents participants and unresolved conditions have been identified. Do not request accounts of violence or home addresses to establish a need.

Record for this phase:

Agreement to review	Responsible role	Next encounter
_____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____

CO-CREATION PATHWAY / 03

Compare options and co-design a trial

Choose a feasible response with the community, including changing practices, repairing, combining solutions or postponing installation.

What to do

Turn each priority into criteria: expected service, total cost, care time, climate, available materials and repairability. Compare at least two options using drawings or simple models. Choose the thermal or photovoltaic workshop only when it helps answer the group's questions. Obtain technical review of loads, structure, protection and compatibility. Agree a small trial, what to observe and when to decide.

Questions for dialogue

Why do we prefer this option? What happens in poor weather or if someone leaves? Which costs and care tasks are missing from the initial price? What result would make us change our minds?

What to agree and keep

An option comparison and a trial agreement: service, limits, budget, responsible roles, observations and review date. Record why each option is chosen or rejected.

When to continue or adapt

Continue when the community makes an informed, understandable choice and the technology and space are suitable. If support for use of the space is missing or the trial fails, review before investing or installing.

Record for this phase:

Agreement to review	Responsible role	Next encounter
_____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____

CO-CREATION PATHWAY / 04

Put decisions into practice, learn and hand over together

Ensure people understand the service, its limits and its care needs, with real responsibilities and support at handover.

What to do

Before intervention, confirm agreements for use of the space and responsibilities, with competent advice where needed. Qualified personnel must carry out installation and electrical tests. Combine demonstration with participants explaining in their own words what each part does, what they can inspect visually and when to request help. Hand over manuals, warranties, an inventory and a simple fault protocol. Budget for maintenance and replacements.

Questions for dialogue

Can we explain the limits without relying on the installer? Who responds to a fault, within what timeframe and using what resources? How do we share care without overburdening the same people?

What to agree and keep

An agreed handover: recorded technical tests, practical explanation, care rota, private support channel and first review date. Separate private technical records from authorised public evidence.

When to continue or adapt

Do not regard handover as complete just because equipment turns on. If fault response is missing or use is unclear, complete training and support before closing this phase.

Record for this phase:

Agreement to review	Responsible role	Next encounter
_____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____

CO-CREATION PATHWAY / 05

Provide follow-up, evaluate and sustain the network

Care for continuity beyond a workshop, a visit or the student team's graduation.

What to do

Agree adaptable reviews, for example after one month, three months and one year. Evaluate services chosen by the community: lighting hours, access to learning, care time or continuity of activities. Ask about new burdens and problems too. If the university team changes, agree a handover before leaving and confirm the replacement team's response capacity. Include exchanges between initiatives and return every result to the community before publication.

Questions for dialogue

Has what mattered to us improved? Who benefits and who does more work? What should we repair or change? Who will keep responding and how will we know? Which learning is worth sharing?

What to agree and keep

A joint review with agreed changes, a responsible person or institution by role, available resources and the next date. Keep contacts private. Graduates and partners can sustain the network when concrete agreements are in place.

When to continue or adapt

Close each cycle with feedback and accepted next steps. Do not promise unlimited support: explain what can actually be sustained and agree alternatives before a partnership ends.

Record for this phase:

Agreement to review	Responsible role	Next encounter
_____ _____	_____ _____	_____ _____

EXPLAINED CHECKLIST

01 / The community defined its priorities and agreements.

Why it matters

Prevents an institution's proposal being confused with a community decision.

How to review it

Return the summary in everyday language and review it with different voices. Ask who is missing, which disagreements remain and how decisions are made. Record the expected service and the ability to change or decline the proposal.

Minimum evidence

A short validated record or drawing: three priorities, choice criteria, decision method and next review. No names or location in the public copy.

When to check / what to do if missing

Check when participants recognise their priorities and accept the agreements; if exclusions or unresolved disagreements affect the decision, return to listening.

02 / Materials suit local weather and resources.

Why it matters

The same technology or activity does not work equally well everywhere.

How to review it

Review language, literacy, accessibility, timing, care work, sunlight and locally repairable materials. Try a small activity. Compare expectations with actual conditions; prepare an alternative for rain or missing equipment.

Minimum evidence

An adaptation sheet: what changed, why, which roles agreed and what the trial showed. Add competent review for technical matters.

When to check / what to do if missing

Check when the trial is understandable and feasible with available resources. If it relies on inaccessible supplies, change materials or scope before repeating it.

EXPLAINED CHECKLIST

03 / Technical support and a maintenance plan are in place.

Why it matters

Equipment without maintenance or fault response can become a new burden.

How to review it

Agree tasks, rota, costs, warranties, repair and succession. Confirm who will respond to faults and which actions require qualified personnel. Review conditions for use of the space before investing. Keep the contact list out of publications.

Minimum evidence

A plan with task, frequency, responsible role, technical backup, planned resources and review. Manuals and test records remain available to users.

When to check / what to do if missing

Check when responsibilities are accepted and support is confirmed. If fault response or minimum resources are missing, adjust scope and do not declare a completed handover.

04 / Every record has consent and protects personal data.

Why it matters

Participation does not imply consent to photographs, recordings or internet publication.

How to review it

Explain the recording purpose, audience and publication destination. Separate permission to record, keep and publish. Offer participation without appearing. Review faces, voices, signs, maps, metadata and backgrounds. Authorisation for the video applies to that video; it does not authorise every file.

Minimum evidence

A private permission record per file and review of the final version. Publish only the authorised selection, using neutral filenames and reviewed metadata.

When to check / what to do if missing

Check when every selected file has permission for that destination and its content has been reviewed. Do not publish without permission. Explain that downloaded copies or public history may prevent complete withdrawal.

EXPLAINED CHECKLIST

05 / Learning will be evaluated with the community.

Why it matters

Counting equipment, visits or watts alone does not show whether everyday life improved or knowledge can be used.

How to review it

Choose two or three observable changes with the community and describe the starting situation without collecting unnecessary data. Ask people to explain or demonstrate a learning. Schedule feedback and ask what failed and who took on extra work.

Minimum evidence

A sheet with expected change, initial observation, review method, responsible role, date and subsequent decision. Record corrections requested by the community.

When to check / what to do if missing

Check when agreed criteria and a scheduled review exist, rather than only an end-of-session survey. If nobody can return results or follow up, agree a replacement or reduce scope.

Closing the review

For every criterion, write what is missing, which role will review it and by when. The boxes do not grade the community. If an important condition is missing, change the plan. Keep contacts and permissions in a private file.

Continuity and next steps

Service we want to improve: _____
Change we will observe: _____
Agreed support and succession: _____
Date and method for returning results: _____